

Shape the ground. The world grows. Count what bloomed.

The only builder where you place nothing — you shape the ground, and a living world grows itself.

The core loop (one Year)

1 • Shape

12 Moons. Each Moon: **act** (Uplift, Subduct, rain, seed — costs mana) or **rest** (free). Either way the world runs 12 ticks: water walks, soil moves, life spreads.

2 • Harvest

Count what stands. **Bloom = living hexes × (1 + Wonders)**. Wonders are shapes the water made: a Lake, a River, a Waterfall, an Island, a Ring of Life.

3 • The bar

Bloom ≥ this Year's target → continue. Below it → **the pot rests**: the run ends on the Behold screen. That is the only fail.

4 • Spring

Surplus Bloom becomes **Dew**. Shop: 3 Boons (permanent rule changes) + 2 Seed cards (kinds of life). Same pot, next Year, higher bar.

Eight Years in one pot. Year 1 is a puddle and a patch of moss; Year 8 is a world — or the pot rests earlier, and you behold what you grew.

Moment to moment

- **Read** the pot: where would water go, where is soil gathering, where can life reach.
- **Spend a Moon**: dig a basin (1 mana), raise a ridge (2), hang a cloud (3), sow a seed (1), or rest (0).
- **Watch** 12 ticks: the basin fills, the shore greens one hex a tick, the slag fan grows.
- **Plan** the next Moon from what you saw. Nothing moves while you think; nothing is random.

What you win by

- **Count**: living hexes. Life needs a course of soil, not drowned, and visible water beside it (a lake tile or a river).
- **Shape**: Wonders multiply the count. They are about water and terrain, so "cover everything in moss" never wins.

The numbers (first guesses, tune by play)

THING	VALUE
Moon	12 ticks
Year	12 Moons
Run	8 Years, ~40 min
Mana / Year	10, no carry-over
Action cost	brush ×1..×4 · depth ×1..×3
Cloud	3 per rain tile
Seed	1 + a card
Target Bloom	8 · 15 · 25 · 40 · 60 · 90 · 130 · 180
Dew at Harvest	2 + surplus÷5, cap 10, +interest
Boons held	max 5 · 4–8 Dew each

Cozy mode

Same game, no bar, no clock, 20 mana that carries, the shop as a menu, the Codex as a notebook. A mode — not the spine.

- **Build:** Boons + seeds + the shape you carved agreeing — Lake, River, Highland, Sprawl.

What your brief asked for, and where it landed

YOU ASKED	ANSWER
Sim-board roguelike	One pot, 8 Years, a rising bar, a gentle fail. Decided.
Free-shape + end-of-round score	Shaping stays free-form on any hex; Harvest counts the world as it stands. Decided.
Bloom = Σ living hex $\times$ synergy multipliers	Bloom = living hexes $\times$ (1 + sum of Wonder bonuses). Twelve Wonders listed with detectors. Decided; bonuses to tune.
Mana budget + rising threshold	10 mana a Year, cost = brush $\times$ depth; targets $\times 1.5$ a Year. Numbers flagged.
Spring shop / Boons / builds	3 Boons + 2 Seed cards per Spring, bought with Dew; 12 Boons listed; four builds fall out of them.
Cards	Cards are Seeds (Moss, Grass, Reed, Willow, Pine, Lotus), not shaping actions. This is the one interpretation I chose — veto it if you meant otherwise.
Cozy is a mode	Yes: pressure off, same world, ships in the demo.
Steam-first ~\$13, own art	Kept. Phase 0 beauty pass = palette + light + diorama camera + one post shader, no bought assets on hexes or water.
Life back on the water branch	Done and pushed: three rules, seed on the palette, measured.

Build order (stop and play after each)

#	STEP	PROVES	SIZE
1	Life	life reads from water and soil, no aura	done
2	Phase 0 beauty pass	the look is ours	1 day
3	Harvest: Bloom + Wonders on the bench	is beating your own Bloom fun? — go / no-go	2 days
4	Moons, Years, mana, the bar	the loop has tension	2 days
5	Seed cards: Moss, Grass, Reed	"what to sow" is a decision	1 day
6	Spring shop + 6 Boons	builds emerge	2 days
7	Seeded starting pots	variety without randomness in play	1 day
8	Behold + cozy mode + Codex	the felt moment	2 days
9	Rest of the roster	—	3 days
10	Vertical slice → demo → Next Fest	—	1 week

Five things only you can answer

- **Cards = seeds?** Or did you mean a hand of shaping cards? (Changes step 5.)
- **One pot for eight Years**, or a new pot each Year like Islanders?
- **Count Bloom as it stands** at the last Moon, or after a free settle? (Recommendation: as it stands.)
- **12 ticks a Moon** — decide by playing step 4.

- **Radius 12 or 14** for a run.

Full document: [design/game-design-v0.1.pdf](#) (29 pages, one chapter per page – the same content, with every rule, every Wonder, every Boon and the reasoning). This sheet is the part to argue about.